

Zero Loop Standard Work

IT Town Hall Speech Script

Speaker Jing Yang	Audience IT Town Hall	Style Simple, clear and light
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Core message

We are not adding more work. We are letting the system remember what people should not have to remember.

Print tip: underline the words you want to stress and mark short pauses with a slash: /

Opening

Good morning, everyone.

My name is Jing Yang, from the ELM Tech team.

Today, I would like to share a small automation project called Zero Loop Standard Work.

The name may sound a little serious. But the idea started from a very simple question:

How can I stop worrying at night about whether I finished all my daily checks?

Let me explain.

Slide 1 - Background and Pain Points

As Shift IT, we have many standard tasks.

Some tasks happen every day. Some happen every week. Others happen once a month.

For example, we need to check dashboards, attend meetings, review tickets, check server performance, and send the shift report.

Each task is not very difficult.

The problem is that there are many tasks, and each task has its own time.

Now, let me share a familiar situation.

One day, I had several meetings in the morning. Then an issue came in, so I spent a lot of time working on it.

After I went home, I suddenly thought:

Wait, did I finish the PMX server check today?

I could not remember.

There was also no simple place where I could check the answer.

At that moment, I realized that the problem was not only about memory. It was also about how the work was designed.

We had four main pain points.

First, tasks were easy to forget, especially when urgent support work came in.

Second, the status was difficult to track. We could not easily see what was completed and what was still open.

Third, a new team member might not know what to check, when to check it, or where to find the information.

Finally, the task status was not clearly visible to the team or the manager.

In short, our standard work mostly depended on personal memory.

People had to find the tasks.

So I wanted to change the direction:

Instead of people looking for tasks, could the tasks look for people?

Slide 2 - The Solution

To solve this problem, I used Microsoft 365 tools that we already have.

The solution includes SharePoint, Power Automate, Teams, and Outlook.

Let me explain the process from left to right.

First, SharePoint stores the tasks.

We created a task template for recurring work.

Each task has basic information, such as the task ID, task name, task type, scheduled time, and schedule rule.

For example, a task can run daily, every Monday, every Tuesday, or on the first Monday of each month.

If the task schedule changes, we only need to update the template.

Second, Power Automate is the engine.

Every morning, the first flow reads the task template and creates the tasks for that day.

The flow also prevents duplicate tasks from being created.

This means that even if the flow runs again, the same daily task will not be created twice.

Third, Teams is the reminder channel.

The system checks the task status and scheduled time.

If a task has reached its planned time and is still not completed, the system can remind the Shift IT team in Teams.

We are still improving this reminder experience.

During testing, we found that sending one card for every task could create too many messages. A card that waits for a response can also hold up the tasks behind it.

So the next version will use a simpler reminder summary. It will show the current open tasks in one clear message.

Finally, Outlook will close the daily loop.

The planned end-of-shift email will summarize completed tasks, open tasks, and exceptions.

This part is on our next-step list.

So the full design is simple:

SharePoint stores the work.
Power Automate runs the process.
Teams reminds the team.
Outlook summarizes the result.

This changes standard work from something stored in our heads into something visible in a system.

Slide 3 - Current Status, Next Steps and Takeaways

So, where are we today?

The prototype has been validated.

The task template and daily checklist are in place.

The system can automatically create daily tasks.

It also supports different schedule rules for daily, weekly, and monthly tasks.

Duplicate prevention is working, so one task is created only once for the same day.

The basic Teams reminder and status update functions have also been tested.

At the moment, we are improving the reminder logic and the user experience before a wider rollout.

There are three main next steps.

First, we want to make the reminder experience simpler.

Instead of sending many separate cards, the system can send one summary of the tasks that are due and still open.

When a task is completed, it will disappear from the next reminder summary.

Second, we want to close the daily loop.

At the end of the shift, the system can send a simple report showing completed, pending, and exception items.

Third, we want to use the historical data.

Today, the checklist helps us remember the work.

In the future, the same data can help us understand the work.

For example, we can see which tasks are often late, which tasks often have exceptions, and whether the task schedule needs to change.

There are also three key lessons from this project.

The first lesson is: start small.

We do not need to begin with a large application.

A task template, a checklist, and a few low-code flows can already create value.

The second lesson is: automate memory, not human judgment.

The system does not replace the Shift IT engineer.

The system reminds us and records the status, but the engineer still performs the check and makes the decision.

The third lesson is: design for reuse.

This approach is not only for Shift IT.

Other teams with recurring standard work could use the same idea.

Closing

To summarize, this project is moving our standard work:

**from personal memory to a shared system,
from hidden status to visible status,
and from people looking for tasks to tasks looking for people.**

The core idea is:

**We are not adding more work.
We are letting the system remember what people should not
have to remember.**

And hopefully, this means fewer late-night questions like:

Did I finish that check today?

Thank you.

Quick Delivery Notes

Part	How to deliver it
Opening	Smile and speak slowly. Pause after the question about worrying at night.
Slide 1	Pause after: "Wait, did I finish the PMX server check today?"
Slide 2	Point from left to right: SharePoint, Power Automate, Teams, Outlook.
Slide 3	Slow down for the three lessons: start small, automate memory, design for reuse.
Closing	Pause between the two sentences in the core idea. Look at the audience for the final "Thank you."

Easy pronunciation reminders

recurring: ri-KUR-ing

duplicate: DYOO-pli-kut

exception: ik-SEP-shun

judgment: JUJ-ment

visibility: viz-uh-BIL-uh-tee